Alex Mercer

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Experience

Senior Backend Engineer — Seattle, WA
Nexus Cloud Solutions — *Nov 2022 – Present*

- Architected and deployed scalable microservices processing 5M+ daily requests using Go and gRPC, reducing latency by 40%.
- Migrated legacy monolithic architecture to AWS Elastic Kubernetes Service (EKS), implementing automated CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions.
- Skills: Go, Python, AWS (EKS, S3, RDS), Kubernetes, Docker, gRPC, GitHub Actions.

Software Engineer II — San Francisco, CA
DataStream Analytics — *Feb 2019 – Dec 2021*

- Designed and optimized RESTful APIs for a real-time data visualization dashboard used by 50,000+ enterprise clients.
- Refactored core database queries, improving PostgreSQL query execution time by 60% and reducing server load.
- Skills: Python, Django, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery, Datadog.

Junior Software Engineer — Austin, TX
FinTech Innovators — *Jun 2017 – Jan 2019*

- Developed and maintained responsive frontend components for a secure mobile banking application using React and Redux.
- Collaborated with the QA team to implement unit and integration testing frameworks, increasing test coverage from 45% to 85%.
- Skills: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Redux, Node.js, Jest, Express.

QA Automation Engineer — Chicago, IL
Pioneer Software — *Oct 2016 – May 2017*

- Created comprehensive automated test suites for a proprietary CRM system using Selenium Webdriver and Python.
- Authored technical documentation and debugging runbooks for the tier-2 support team.
- Skills: Python, Selenium, PyTest, Jenkins, Linux, Technical Writing.

Software Engineering Intern — Chicago, IL
Nimbus Dynamics — *Feb 2015 – Apr 2015*

- Developed Python scripts to automate data scraping from public APIs, saving the research team 10 hours of manual data entry per week.
- Assisted senior engineers in migrating legacy front-end components to early iterations of React during the startup's core platform redesign.
- Skills: Python, JavaScript, Git, Bash.

Education

University of Washington
Master of Science (M.S.) in Computer Science — *2020 – 2022*

- Studies: Distributed Systems, Cloud Computing Architectures, Advanced Data Structures.

University of Texas at Austin
Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Software Engineering; Minor in Cognitive Psychology — *2011 – 2015*

- Studies: Operating Systems, Computer Architecture, Algorithm Analysis.
- Interdisciplinary focus: Completed advanced coursework in behavioral economics, human-computer interaction (HCI), and the sociology of digital communities.

Santa Fe Institute
Complex Systems Summer School — *Summer 2014*

- Intensive undergraduate fellowship exploring non-linear dynamics, emergence, and network theory outside standard computing paradigms.

Projects and Activities

Distributed Load Balancer — Oct 2023
Developer — *Open Source Contribution*

- Built a layer-4 network load balancer in Go, capable of distributing traffic across multiple backend servers using round-robin and least-connections algorithms.

Seattle Tech Mentorship Jan 2023 – Present
Mentor *Community involvement*

- Provide weekly coding mentorship and architectural guidance to coding bootcamp graduates transitioning into software engineering careers.

Seattle Speculative Fiction Collective Feb 2021 – Present
Co-Founder & Facilitator *Community involvement*

- Organize bi-weekly reading groups analyzing magical realism, speculative fiction, and the socio-economic themes of automated futures in modern literature.
- Coordinate quarterly author Q&A sessions and local indie bookstore partnerships to promote emerging regional writers.

Skills and Interests

Technical: Go, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Java, SQL, Operating Systems (Linux, macOS), Cloud (AWS, Google Cloud), Containers (Docker, Kubernetes), Frameworks (Django, React, Node.js), Databases (PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis), Version Control (Git, GitHub), CI/CD, Agile.

Certifications: AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate, Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA).

Languages: English (native), Spanish (intermediate).

Interests: Rock climbing, urban sketching, magical realism literature, mechanical keyboards, embedded systems.